

NEW ZEALAND UNIVERSITIES: TRENDS IN INTERNATIONAL ENROLMENTS

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International Division
Ministry of Education

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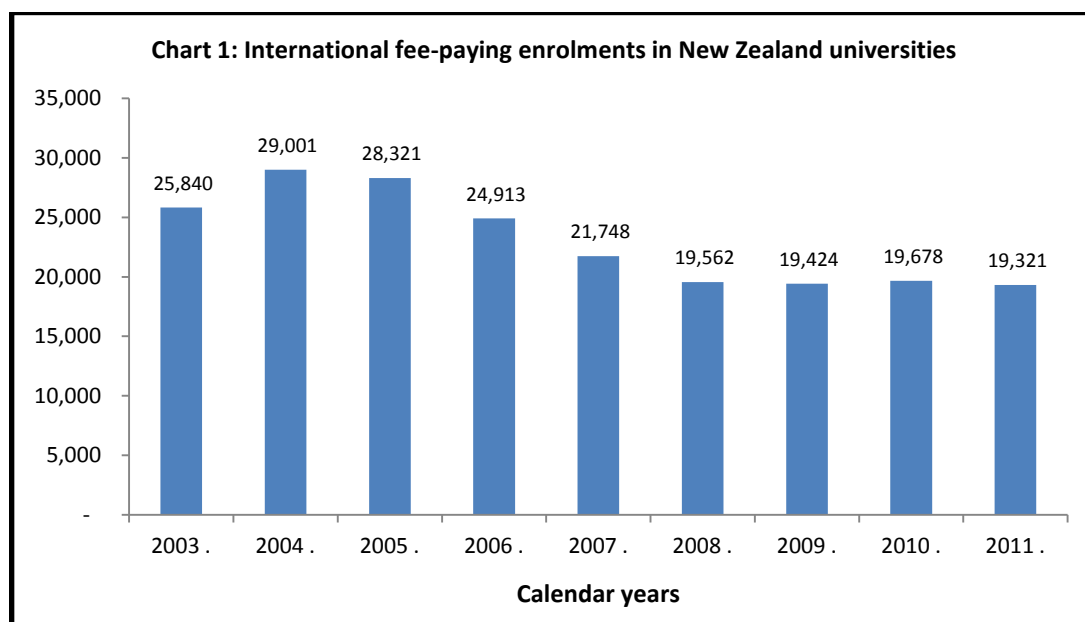
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Introduction

This report summarises the latest available information on international enrolments – particularly fee-paying enrolments – across New Zealand's eight universities. Information from the Export Education Levy is presented on the trend in university enrolments from 2003 to 2011, the regional breakdown from 2007 to 2011, and the main source countries for international students (and their respective values). Information from the Tertiary Single Data Return is presented on the main subject areas in which international students are enrolled, and on the trend in enrolments of international Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) students.

1. The trend in university international enrolments

International fee-paying enrolments in New Zealand universities peaked at 29,001 in 2004. There was a steady decline from 2004 to 2008, driven mainly by a marked fall in new enrolments of Chinese students. There were 19,321 international fee-paying student enrolments during the 2011 calendar year.

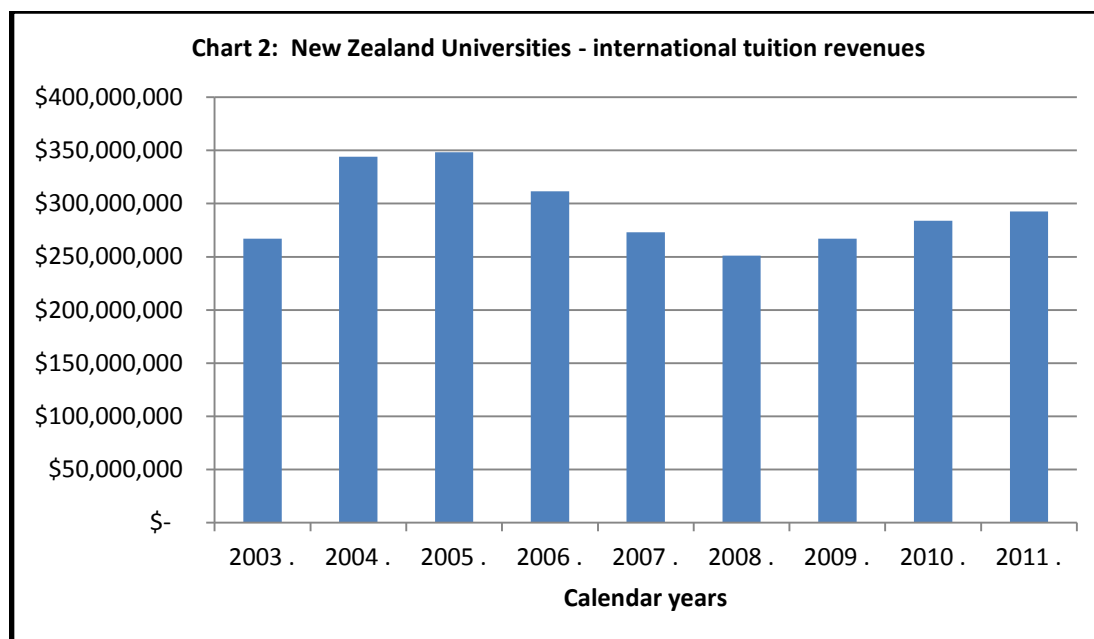


2. The trend in international tuition revenues

The tuition revenues earned by the universities from international fee-paying students largely kept pace with the trend in enrolments, until 2009. There has been a continued rise in revenues from 2009 to 2011, while enrolment levels have remained static. Revenues amounted to \$292.7 million in 2011, a 3% rise from 2010.

Calendar year	University international tuition revenues (\$NZ)	Annual % change
2003	\$266,917,015	
2004	\$343,996,835	29%
2005	\$348,240,216	1%
2006	\$311,663,309	-11%
2007	\$273,075,934	-12%
2008	\$251,075,934	-8%
2009	\$266,969,203	6%
2010	\$284,008,792	6%
2011	\$292,715,800	3%

Source: Export Education Levy, Ministry of Education



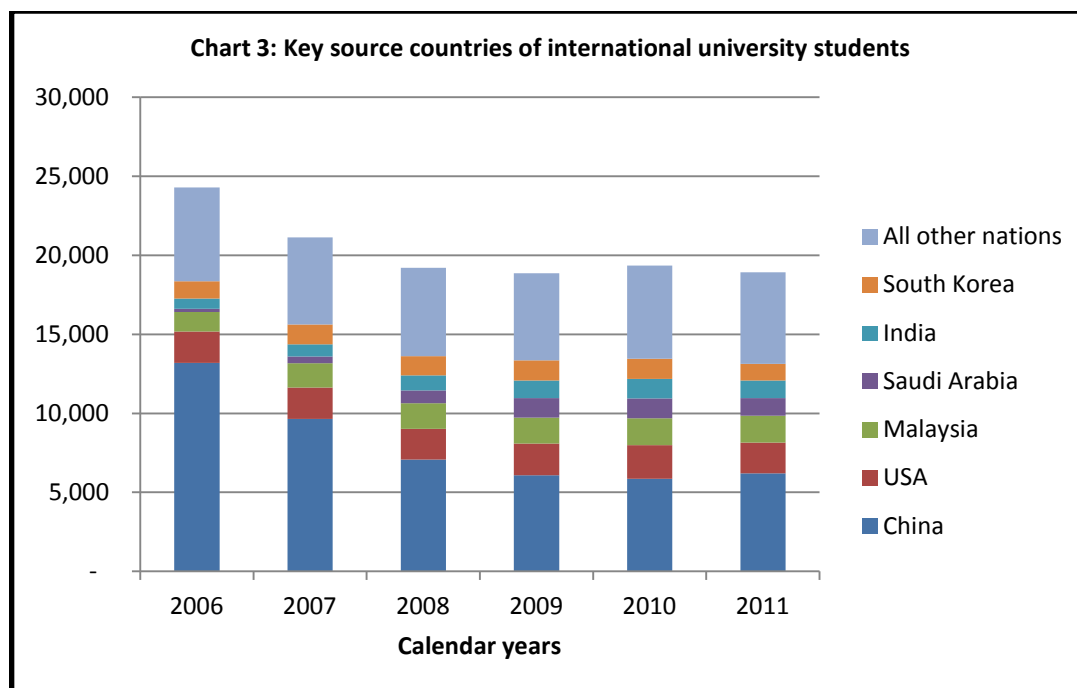
3. Key source countries of international students

The next table and chart shows the trend in the key source countries for international fee-paying students enrolled in the universities, from 2006 to 2011. The fall in Chinese student enrolments from 2006 to 2009 is apparent, as is the increase in enrolments from India and Saudi Arabia. USA student numbers have been relatively constant over time.

University international enrolments by country	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011
China	13,202	9,648	7,066	6,092	5,864	6,199
USA	1,983	1,994	1,947	1,989	2,115	1,945
Malaysia	1,238	1,539	1,627	1,656	1,717	1,702
Saudi Arabia	201	421	814	1,220	1,245	1,121
India	640	768	946	1,126	1,240	1,104
South Korea	1,104	1,252	1,213	1,268	1,279	1,055
All other nations	5,921	5,514	5,595	5,519	5,890	5,792
Totals	24,289	21,136	19,208	18,870	19,350	18,918

Note: The annual total of students differs from the total of enrolments, because a small number of students enrol more than once each year.

Source: Export Education Levy, Ministry of Education



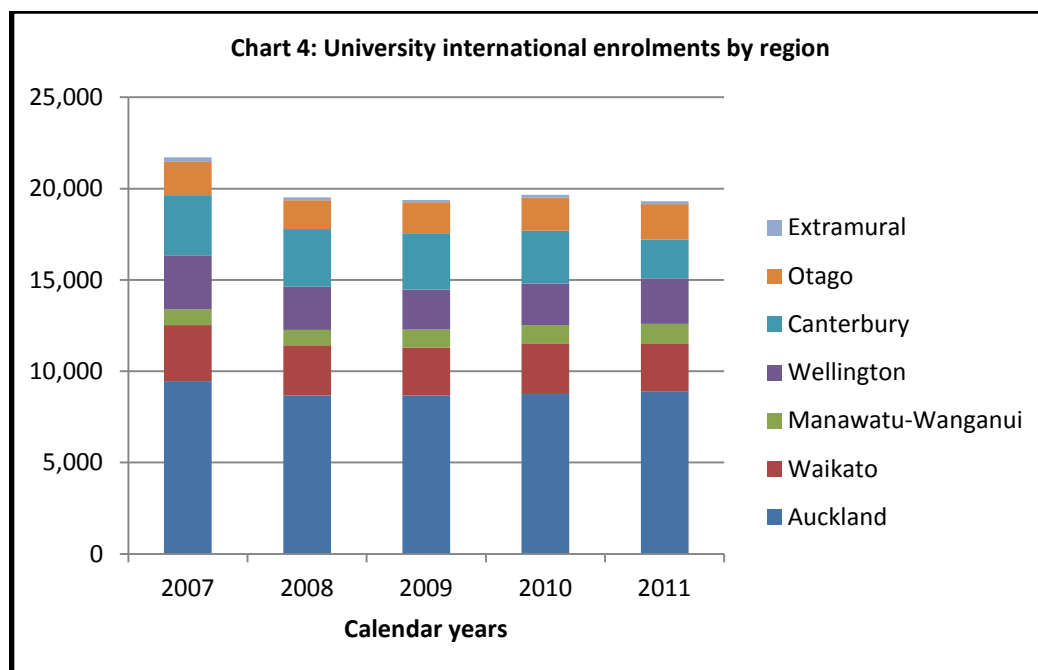
The most valuable international student nationalities for the universities are set out in the next table. The calculations are based on the average tuition fee (per Equivalent Full Time Student) for international enrolments in the universities, which was \$20,766 for the 2011 calendar year. It is apparent that China is the most valuable source of students, followed by the United States, Malaysia, and Saudi Arabia.

Main student nationalities	University enrolments, 2011	Estimated total tuition
China	6,199	\$128,728,434
United States	1,945	\$40,389,870
Malaysia	1,702	\$35,343,732
Saudi Arabia	1,121	\$23,278,686
India	1,104	\$22,925,664
South Korea	1,055	\$21,908,130
Japan	938	\$19,478,508
Germany	377	\$7,828,782
Taiwan	283	\$5,876,778
Thailand	260	\$5,399,160

4. International enrolments by regional council area

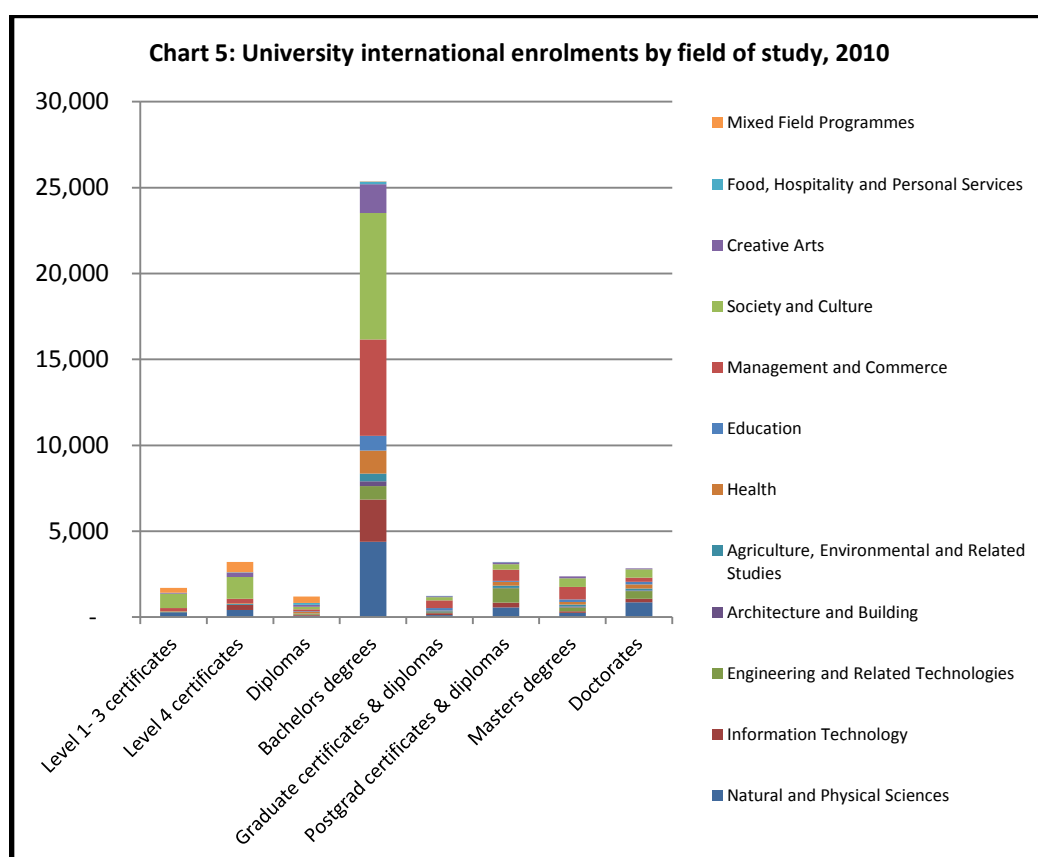
The eight universities are based (with the exception of Massey University, which has multiple campuses) in specific New Zealand regions. A key change since 2010 has been the consequences of the Christchurch earthquake of 22 February 2011, which has led to a 27% decline in international enrolments in Canterbury.

University international student enrolments, by regional council	2010	2011	% of total, 2011	% change, 2010-11
Auckland	8,764	8,883	46%	1%
Waikato	2,766	2,609	14%	-6%
Manawatu-Wanganui	1,001	1,111	6%	11%
Wellington	2,273	2,477	13%	9%
Canterbury	2,899	2,124	11%	-27%
Otago	1,790	1,947	10%	9%
Extramural	166	158	1%	-5%
Total	19,659	19,309	100%	-2%



5. International enrolments by subject category

It is apparent that the great majority of international students in universities enrol in Bachelors degrees, and particularly study subjects in the fields of *Society and Culture*, *Management and Commerce*, and *Natural and Physical Sciences*.



Note: Total field of study enrolments greatly exceed the actual number of international students, because of multiple enrolments in subjects.

International students enrolled in Universities by field of study, 2010	Level 1- 3 certificates	Level 4 certificates	Diplomas	Bachelors degrees	Graduate certificates & diplomas	Postgraduate certificates & diplomas	Masters degrees	Doctorates
Natural and Physical Sciences	280	420	90	4,390	110	570	240	870
Information Technology	-	290	40	2,450	120	270	110	190
Engineering and Related Technologies	50	-	70	780	50	850	220	460
Architecture and Building	-	-	-	290	10	20	50	40
Agriculture, Environmental and Related Studies	-	70	10	440	50	130	110	110
Health	10	30	100	1,340	40	210	160	240
Education	-	-	40	860	150	60	150	150
Management and Commerce	180	250	110	5,610	440	650	710	240
Society and Culture	850	1,270	140	7,360	190	330	520	480
Creative Arts	50	270	120	1,680	50	110	100	50
Food, Hospitality and Personal Services	-	10	100	140	10	10	-	-
Mixed Field Programmes	280	610	370	10	-	-	-	-
Students	950	1,750	780	12,820	840	2,280	1,990	2,800

Source: Education Counts (www.educationcounts.govt.nz)

6. International students by university

There are varying levels of international student enrolments across the eight universities, ranging from 9% to 31% of the respective total student bodies. In 2010 the average proportion was 13%.

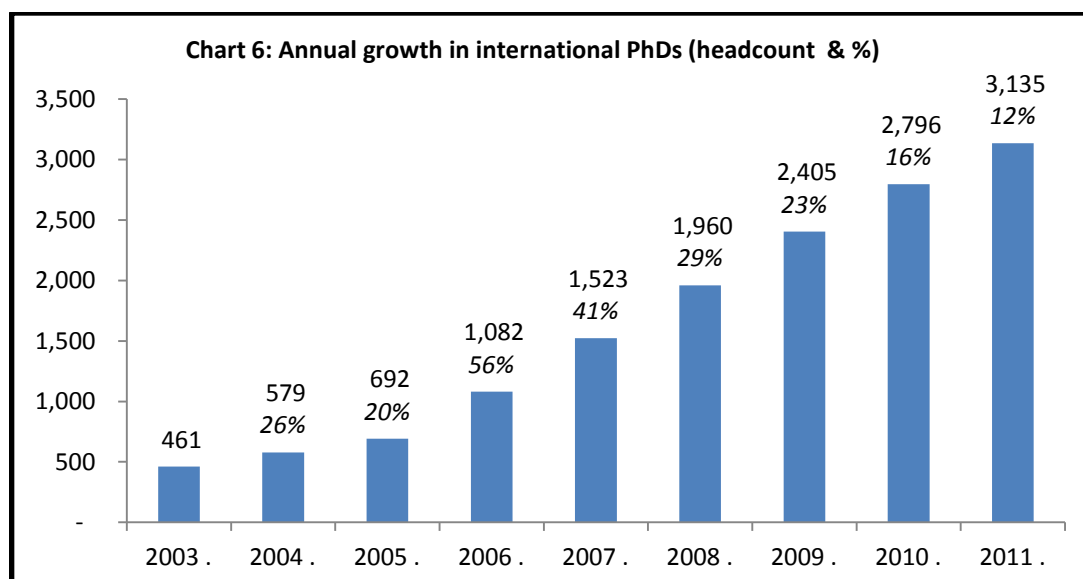
Domestic and international students, 2010	Domestic	International	<i>International as a proportion of total</i>
University of Auckland	36,263	4,713	12%
University of Waikato	10,590	2,251	18%
Massey University	31,223	3,200	9%
Victoria University of Wellington	20,082	2,800	12%
University of Canterbury	16,375	2,121	11%
Lincoln University	2,288	1,008	31%
University of Otago	19,263	2,687	12%
Auckland University of Technology	21,773	4,266	16%
Total	157,857	23,046	13%

Notes: The figures for the University of Canterbury and Lincoln University do not reflect the consequences of the Christchurch earthquakes during 2011.

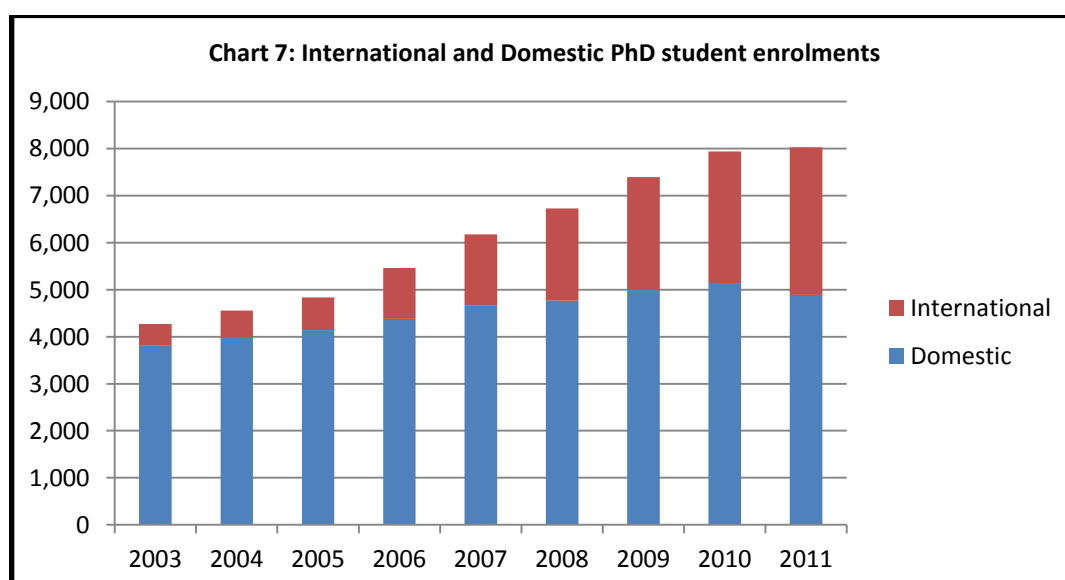
The total of international students includes people with domestic fee status (particularly PhD students), and so is different to the total of fee-paying students.

7. Enrolments of international PhD students

A key policy to support the internationalisation of postgraduate education in New Zealand universities is the extension of domestic fees status for international Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) students. This policy was announced on 19 April 2005, and put in place from 2006. The policy has contributed to a rapid growth in international PhD enrolments, rising from 692 in 2005 to 3,135 in 2011.



It is apparent that the great majority of the growth in PhD enrolments since 2003 has been due to increased international students. Domestic PhD enrolments have shown relatively modest but consistent annual growth, with the headcount rising an overall 24% from 4,140 in 2005 (the introduction of the domestic fees policy) to 5,142 in 2010. There was a reduction in domestic PhD enrolments to 4,892 in 2011.



The following table presents a comparison of the respective international PhD enrolments in 2005 (i.e. before the domestic fees policy was introduced) and 2011, broken down by university. In 2011 international PhD students made up around **39%** of total domestic and international PhD enrolments in New Zealand's eight universities.

The overall ratio of international PhD enrolments is now higher than those reported in Australia and the United Kingdom. In Australia, overseas students made up 29% of the total 46,727 doctorate students during 2010. In the United Kingdom, non-European Union students made up 26% of all 536,810 postgraduate students during the 2008/09 period (data on the breakdown of doctoral students is not currently listed on the website of the UK's Higher Education Statistics Agency).

International PhD enrolments by New Zealand university	2005	2011	% change, 2005 - 2011
University of Auckland	193	703	264%
University of Otago	128	495	287%
Massey University	122	468	284%
University of Canterbury	102	475	366%
Victoria University of Wellington	61	447	633%
University of Waikato	45	260	478%
Lincoln University	32	161	403%
Auckland University of Technology	10	137	1,270%
Total international PhD students*	692	3,135	352%
Total domestic PhD students**	4,140	4,892	18%
International as a % of total	14%	39%	

* the total of *students* is slightly lower than the total of *enrolments* at each university, because a small number of students are counted as being enrolled in more than one university (i.e. through joint programmes).

** Domestic PhD enrolments *exclude* the students enrolled by Unitec and a wānanga.

The 'top 5' nationalities of international PhD students are Malaysia, China, the USA, India and Germany. No single country provides more than 11% of international PhD students. The following table lists all the source countries which provided more than 50 PhD students during 2011.

Main source countries of international PhD students in New Zealand universities	2010	2011	% of total, 2011	% change, 2010-11
Malaysia	329	351	11%	7%
United States of America	233	248	8%	6%
Germany	216	218	7%	1%
India	213	234	7%	10%
China	201	258	8%	28%
Pakistan	176	214	7%	22%
United Kingdom	142	158	5%	11%
Islamic Republic of Iran	115	158	5%	37%
Canada	101	105	3%	4%
Thailand	92	90	3%	-2%
Viet Nam	73	83	3%	14%
France	65	71	2%	9%
Chile	53	52	2%	-2%
Indonesia	48	62	2%	29%
Sri Lanka	46	63	2%	37%
All other nations	693	770	25%	11%
Total	2,796	3,135	100%	12%